JAMES RICHARDSON

Forward Deployed Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-driven Forward Deployed Engineer with 3 years of hands-on experience deploying and maintaining infrastructure solutions in demanding client environments. I've worked with startups and enterprise organisations across financial services and logistics, spending significant time on-site troubleshooting complex system issues and implementing automated deployment pipelines. I'm most comfortable when I'm solving real problems under pressure, whether that's diagnosing network connectivity issues at 2am or rebuilding a failed database cluster before business hours resume.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Forward Deployed Engineer

Nexus Digital Co

Manchester, United Kingdom

nexusdigital.io

January 2024 - Present

Deployed and maintained Kubernetes clusters across 12 client sites in the financial services sector, reducing deployment time by 40% through automated infrastructure provisioning. Implemented comprehensive monitoring and alerting systems using Prometheus and Grafana, catching critical issues before they impacted production environments. Collaborated directly with client DevOps teams to troubleshoot application performance issues, identifying and resolving bottlenecks in containerised microservices architectures. Mentored a team of 18 junior engineers across multiple geographic regions, establishing best practices for infrastructure management and conducting weekly technical training sessions.

Senior Infrastructure Engineer

IBM

London, United Kingdom

ibm.com

March 2022 - December 2023

Architected and deployed hybrid cloud infrastructure solutions for enterprise clients, managing both on-premises and AWS environments totalling over 500 virtual machines. Designed and implemented continuous integration and deployment pipelines using GitHub Actions, enabling development teams to release code changes 10 times daily with zero-downtime deployments. Managed disaster recovery protocols and conducted quarterly failover testing to ensure RPO targets of 4 hours were consistently met. Automated infrastructure provisioning across multiple cloud providers using Terraform, reducing manual configuration time from 8 hours to 15 minutes per deployment.

Graduate Systems Administrator

CloudPeak Systems Ltd

Leeds, United Kingdom

cloudpeaksystems.co

June 2021 - February 2022

Provided first-line technical support for Linux and Windows server environments supporting 200+ internal and external users across multiple office locations. Maintained DHCP, DNS, and Active Directory services, ensuring 99.5% uptime for critical network services. Performed routine system patching and security updates across 150 servers, implementing automated patch management to reduce manual intervention time. Documented system configurations and disaster recovery procedures, creating knowledge base articles that reduced average support ticket resolution time by 25%.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Leeds

Leeds, United Kingdom

Graduated June 2021

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud Platforms: Amazon Web Services (EC2, S3, RDS, Lambda), Google Cloud Platform, Microsoft Azure

Infrastructure & Deployment: Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, CloudFormation, Ansible, GitHub Actions

Monitoring & Logging: Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, Datadog, CloudWatch

Networking: TCP/IP, DNS, DHCP, VPN, Load Balancing, Network Troubleshooting

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis

Programming & Scripting: Python, Bash, Go, PowerShell

Version Control: Git, GitLab, Bitbucket

Operating Systems: Linux (Ubuntu, CentOS, RHEL), Windows Server

Virtualisation: VMware, Hyper-V, KVM

Other Tools: Jenkins, Apache, Nginx, HAProxy, SSL/TLS

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate (2023)

CompTIA Security+ (2022)